

NEXORA TECHNOLOGIES INC.

Operational Guidelines

This is a fictional, synthetic document created for a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) practice project. Nexora Technologies Inc. is not a real company. All names, IDs, amounts, IP addresses, and contact details in this document are randomly generated and do not correspond to any real person or system.

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Owner: IT Security & Operations Department

Companion document to: Nexora Employee Policy Handbook v3.2

1. IT & Security Guidelines

These guidelines translate the Data Privacy & Confidentiality Policy (Section 3 of the Employee Policy Handbook) into day-to-day technical practice for all employees and contractors with access to Nexora systems.

1.1 Password and Authentication Requirements

- Minimum 14-character passphrase for all corporate accounts; no reuse of the last 10 passwords.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for VPN, email, HRIS, and all Restricted-data systems.
- Shared or generic accounts are prohibited except for approved service accounts registered with IT Security.
- Passwords must never be written down, stored in plaintext files, or shared via chat or email.

1.2 Device Management

All laptops issued to employees are enrolled in Nexora's Mobile Device Management (MDM) platform prior to first use. Full-disk encryption (BitLocker or FileVault) is enforced automatically. Personal devices used to access Nexora email or Slack must be enrolled in the BYOD MDM profile within 48 hours of first connection or access will be revoked.

1.3 Data Classification Handling Rules

Tier	Examples	Storage	Sharing Rules
Public	Job postings, blog posts, press releases	Any approved platform	No restriction
Internal	Org charts, roadmaps, internal wikis	Google Drive (Nexora org), Confluence	Nexora employees only
Restricted	SSNs/national IDs, salaries, medical data, HRIS, internal documents	HRIS, internal documents only	Named individuals with documented business need; MFA

1.4 Approved Cloud Infrastructure

Production workloads run on AWS accounts under the nexora-prod organization, region us-east-1 (primary) and eu-central-1 (EU customer data residency). Engineers must not provision resources in personal or unapproved cloud accounts. The internal admin bastion is reachable only via VPN at 10.42.0.0/16, and direct SSH from the public internet is disabled at the security-group level.

2. Remote Work Guidelines

Nexora operates a hybrid-first model. Employees in Engineering, Product, and Customer Success may work remotely up to 4 days per week; roles requiring lab or hardware access must be on-site per their department's schedule.

2.1 Home Office Requirements

- Minimum internet connection of 25 Mbps download / 5 Mbps upload.
- Company-issued laptop must be used for all work involving Internal or Restricted data; personal computers may not be used to access the HRIS or the customer database.
- Video calls involving Restricted data discussions must not be conducted in public spaces (cafes, co-working lounges) without headphones and a privacy screen.

2.2 Working Hours and Time Zones

Remote employees must maintain at least 4 hours of overlap with their team's core collaboration window, published on the internal Confluence space for each department. Time-zone exceptions require manager approval and are logged in Workday.

2.3 International Remote Work

Employees relocating internationally for more than 30 consecutive days must file a Remote Work Location Change request with People & Culture at least 3 weeks in advance, due to tax, payroll, and data residency implications. Unauthorized extended international work is a policy violation under Section 6 of the Employee Policy Handbook.

3. Expense & Reimbursement Guidelines

All business expenses must be submitted through the Expensify portal within 30 days of being incurred, with itemized receipts attached for any single expense over \$25.

3.1 Spending Limits by Category

Category	Domestic Limit	International Limit	Approval Needed Above
Meals (per day)	\$60	\$85	Department Head
Hotel (per night)	\$220	\$300	Department Head
Ground transport	\$50/day	\$70/day	Manager
Client entertainment	\$150/event	\$220/event	VP-level
Conference / training	\$2,500/yr	\$3,500/yr	VP-level

3.2 Sample Reimbursement Record (Restricted — Finance Use Only)

Included to simulate Restricted-tier financial/PII data for retrieval testing. All entries below are fictional.

Report ID	Employee	Card (last 4)	Category	Amount	Status
EXP-88213	Sana T. Qureshi	4471	Client entertainment	\$184.50	Approved

EXP-88240	Marcus O. Lindqvist	9902	Conference	\$2,340.00	Pending VP approval
EXP-88255	Grace N. Owusu	3316	Hotel (3 nights)	\$660.00	Approved
EXP-88271	Daniyal F. Sheikh	5588	Ground transport	\$142.75	Approved

4. Data Handling & Incident Response Guidelines

This section operationalizes breach-reporting obligations under Section 3.4 of the Employee Policy Handbook.

4.1 Incident Severity Levels

Level	Definition	Response Time	Notification
SEV-1	Confirmed exposure of Restricted data to unauthorized parties	Immediate (<1 hr)	CISO, Legal, affected individuals
SEV-2	Suspected but unconfirmed exposure; system compromise without data loss	4 hr	CISO, IT Security
SEV-3	Policy violation with no data exposure (e.g., unencrypted internal file share)	48 hr	IT Security

4.2 Sample Incident Log (Restricted — Security Team Use Only)

Fictional entries simulating a security incident log, for retrieval-testing purposes only.

Incident ID	Date	Severity	Reported By	Summary
INC-2026-014	2026-02-11	SEV-2	Amelia J. Ferro	Phishing email led to MFA prompt approval; account locked pending review.
INC-2026-021	2026-03-04	SEV-1	Rohan K. Batra	Misconfigured S3 bucket briefly exposed export of customer contact records.
INC-2026-033	2026-04-19	SEV-3	Daniyal F. Sheikh	Internal roadmap doc shared to a public Google Drive link for 2 hours.

5. Vendor & Third-Party Guidelines

Any third party that will access Internal or Restricted Nexora data must complete a Vendor Security Review before onboarding.

5.1 Vendor Security Review Process

- Step 1: Requesting department submits a Vendor Intake Form to Procurement.
- Step 2: IT Security reviews the vendor's SOC 2 Type II report (or equivalent) and data flow diagram.
- Step 3: Legal reviews and executes a Data Processing Agreement (DPA) if Restricted data will be shared.
- Step 4: Procurement issues final approval and the vendor is added to the Approved Vendor Registry.

5.2 Prohibited Vendor Practices

Vendors may not subcontract processing of Nexora Restricted data to a fourth party without prior written consent, and may not store Nexora customer data outside the regions specified in the signed DPA.

6. Physical Security Guidelines

All Nexora offices use badge-controlled access. Visitors must be signed in at reception, issued a visitor badge, and escorted at all times in areas beyond the main lobby. Server rooms and network closets require a secondary badge tier held only by IT Operations staff, and access is logged and reviewed monthly by the Security team.

Clean-desk practices apply to all Restricted-data printouts: documents must not be left unattended on desks or printers, and must be shredded using the on-site cross-cut shredders rather than placed in general recycling.

— End of Operational Guidelines —